

Aaron Santanello

Hi, I'm Aaron! I'm a native Californian, turned Utahan. Any given weekday you'll find me at my local East Bench trail head before diving into work. On weekends I'm usually running off to the Ogden mountains or Cottonwoods in search of fresh powder or a manicured mountain bike trail. I thrive to be adventurous in my professional work as well, always looking for ways to connect brands to consumers through forward thinking brand marketing, community activation and storytelling. Below you will find examples of work I've produced over the last 14+ years of my career in the media, brand, sport and community marketing worlds.



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BRAND MANAGEMENT

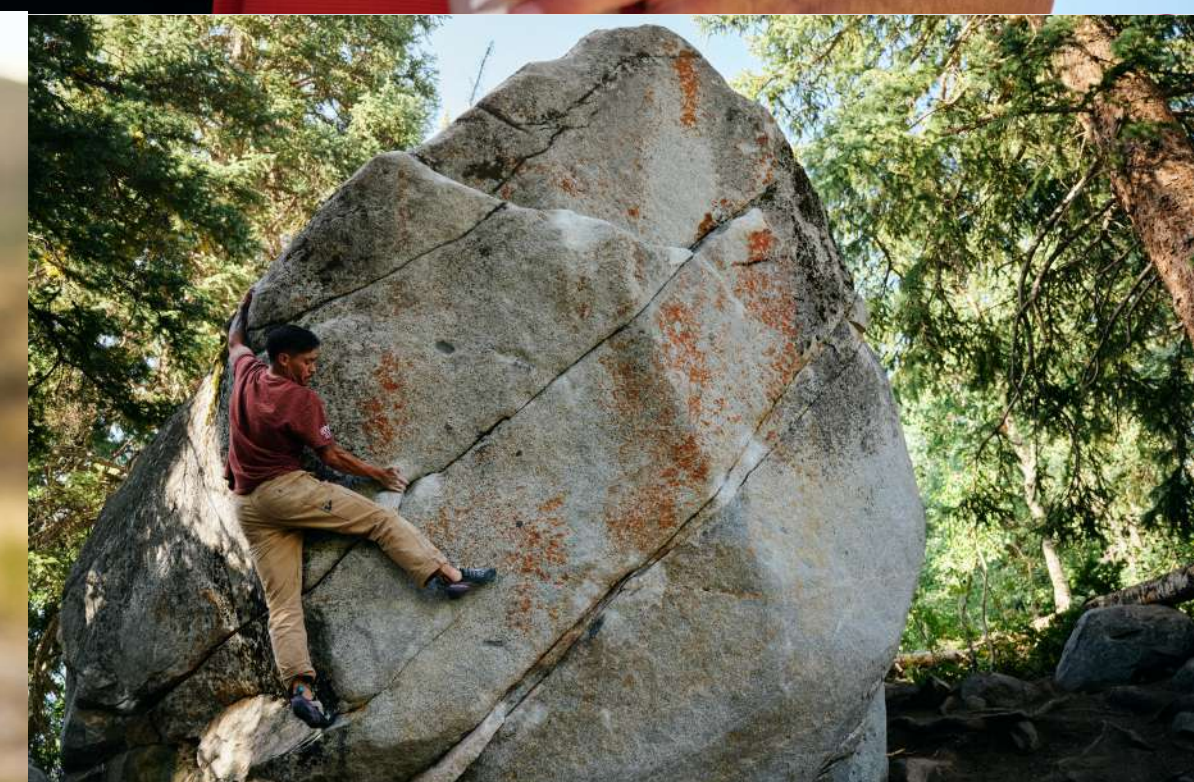
GNARLY NUTRITION

POSITION OVERVIEW | MARKETING DIRECTOR | GNARLY NUTRITION

In this role, I lead Gnarly Nutrition's integrated marketing strategy with full accountability for brand positioning, demand generation, and DTC performance, translating product science and brand ethos into cohesive, full-funnel marketing programs that drive both long-term brand equity and near-term revenue growth. This role owns marketing planning, paid media strategy, partnership and athlete activation, and team leadership, operating as a core business partner to ecommerce, product, sales, and executive leadership to ensure marketing investment delivers measurable commercial impact.

MY INVOLVEMENT:

- **BRAND STRATEGY & POSITIONING:** Define and activate a differentiated brand strategy that clarifies target consumer, category role, and brand voice across all channels.
- **MARKETING PLANNING & OPERATIONS:** Own annual and quarterly marketing plans, aligning campaigns, launches, and budgets to business priorities and revenue goals.
- **DTC BUSINESS OWNERSHIP:** Drive DTC growth and profitability through conversion optimization, merchandising strategy, retention, and lifecycle marketing in close partnership with ecommerce.
- **PAID MEDIA & GROWTH STRATEGY:** Set full-funnel paid media strategy, managing budget allocation, channel mix, and creative performance to balance efficient acquisition with brand building.
- **PARTNERSHIP & ATHLETE ACTIVATION:** Lead strategic partnerships and athlete programs, ensuring authentic brand alignment and measurable impact across content, community, and conversion.
- **TEAM LEADERSHIP:** Build and lead a high-performing marketing team with clear accountability, strong cross-functional collaboration, and a culture of creative and data-driven execution.
- **MEASUREMENT & INSIGHTS:** Establish KPI frameworks and dashboards to evaluate brand health, campaign effectiveness, and ROI, continuously optimizing strategy and spend.





GLOBAL STRATEGY MANAGEMENT

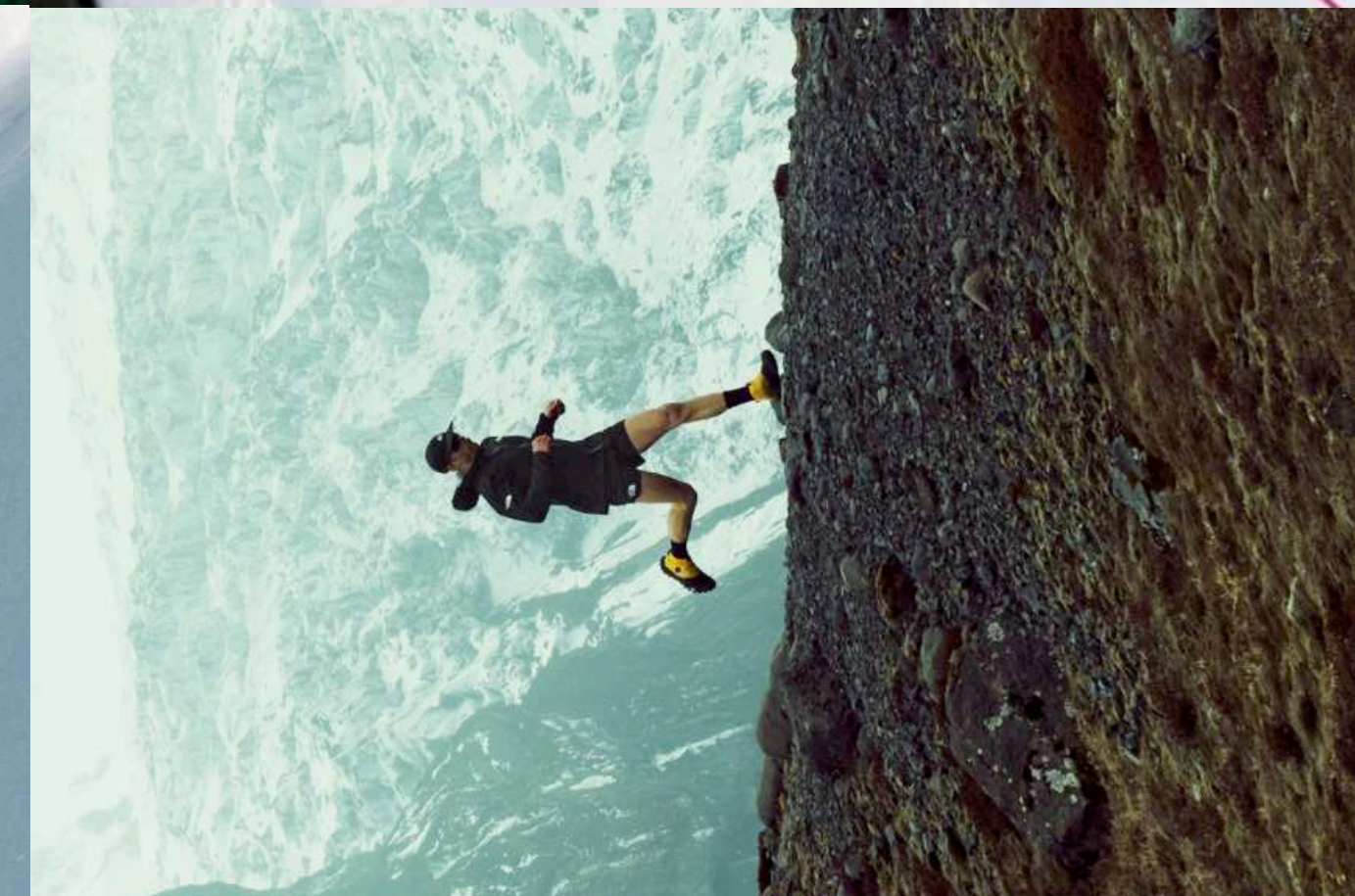
THE NORTH FACE

POSITION OVERVIEW | SR. STRATEGY MANAGER | GLOBAL SPORTS MARKETING

During my tenure I manage strategy, operations and planning for The North Face's Global Sports Marketing team. This entails ownership of a \$12M+ global budget in coordination with Director of Sports Marketing. Oversight of key strategy projects like playbooks and 5-year planning as well as climb, snow and trail category plans. Planning and execution of our Global Athlete Summit. And pro-active collaboration with our internal brand, product and storytelling stakeholders to make sure we are leveraging our athlete team holistically within marketing campaigns, product innovation pipelines and event activations.

MY INVOLVEMENT:

- **STRATEGY WORK STREAM:** Led the adoption of a strategy-first, proactive and planful mindset flexing up on the marketing side of sports marketing execution with our 200+ global athlete team.
- **EXPLORER PROFILE:** Created and implemented the Explorer Profile, a tool to assess an athlete's influence in relation to our target consumer as well as a key framework to manage the athlete lifecycle.
- **ENDORSEMENT FRAMEWORK:** Built an endorsement work stream to better align the right athletes and stories with key brand and product campaigns while directly leveraging integrated athlete owned and operated social channels to drive reach and conversion.
- **GLOBAL ATHLETE SUMMIT:** Led planning and execution of our Global Athlete Summit - including but not limited to theme strategy, programming, sourcing guest speakers, logistical planning for 125+ athletes, etc.
- **HUMAN PERFORMANCE:** Created and pitched senior leadership on a comprehensive service + program to give sports marketing a point of difference within the outdoor market - a program designed to support our athlete team's human potential while in turn providing critical human intellectual property to drive customer engagement, unique brand stories and product innovation [project failed to launch due to budget restriction].





GLOBAL CATEGORY MANAGEMENT

OAKLEY

POSITION OVERVIEW | SENIOR MANAGER, GLOBAL ACTION SPORTS

I managed Oakley's Global Action Sport division connecting the dots between athlete, brand, product and activation. I drove the strategic vision for the surf, snowboard, ski, skateboard and bike categories, identifying and signing the most globally relevant athletes bringing our winning Sports Marketing formula to life. The right athlete x the right product x the right moment = success.

MY INVOLVEMENT:

- **CATEGORY PLANNING:** Managed a \$5M+ global budget ensuring Oakley's Action Sport athlete team is supporting the brands global objectives and growth plans.
- **LEADERSHIP:** Led a direct team of four individuals and six dotted lined reports to scout, sign and drive partnership with the world's most relevant Action Sport athletes.
- **GLOBAL COLLABORATION:** Played quarterback for the Action Sports team translating the division's strategic vision to Oakley's global product, brand comms, performance marketing, and activation teams.
- **PARTNERSHIP MANAGEMENT:** Managed external partnerships with media and sport organizations like the World Surfing League and International Olympic Committee striving for cohesive integration across Oakley's global business functions.
- **RELATIONSHIP BUILDING:** Traveled to key sporting moments throughout the calendar year to support athletes in their endeavors while connecting with industry brands and agents for future potential partnerships [X-Games, Olympics, WSL Stops, World Cup Races, etc].
- **BRAND COMMUNICATION:** Partnered with the Global Brand Comm Director[s] for Action Sports interpreting our business needs into on brand campaigns that serve our top-of-funnel awareness objectives as well as lower-funnel product marketing initiatives.



INTEGRATED MARKETING PARTNERSHIPS

10 BARREL

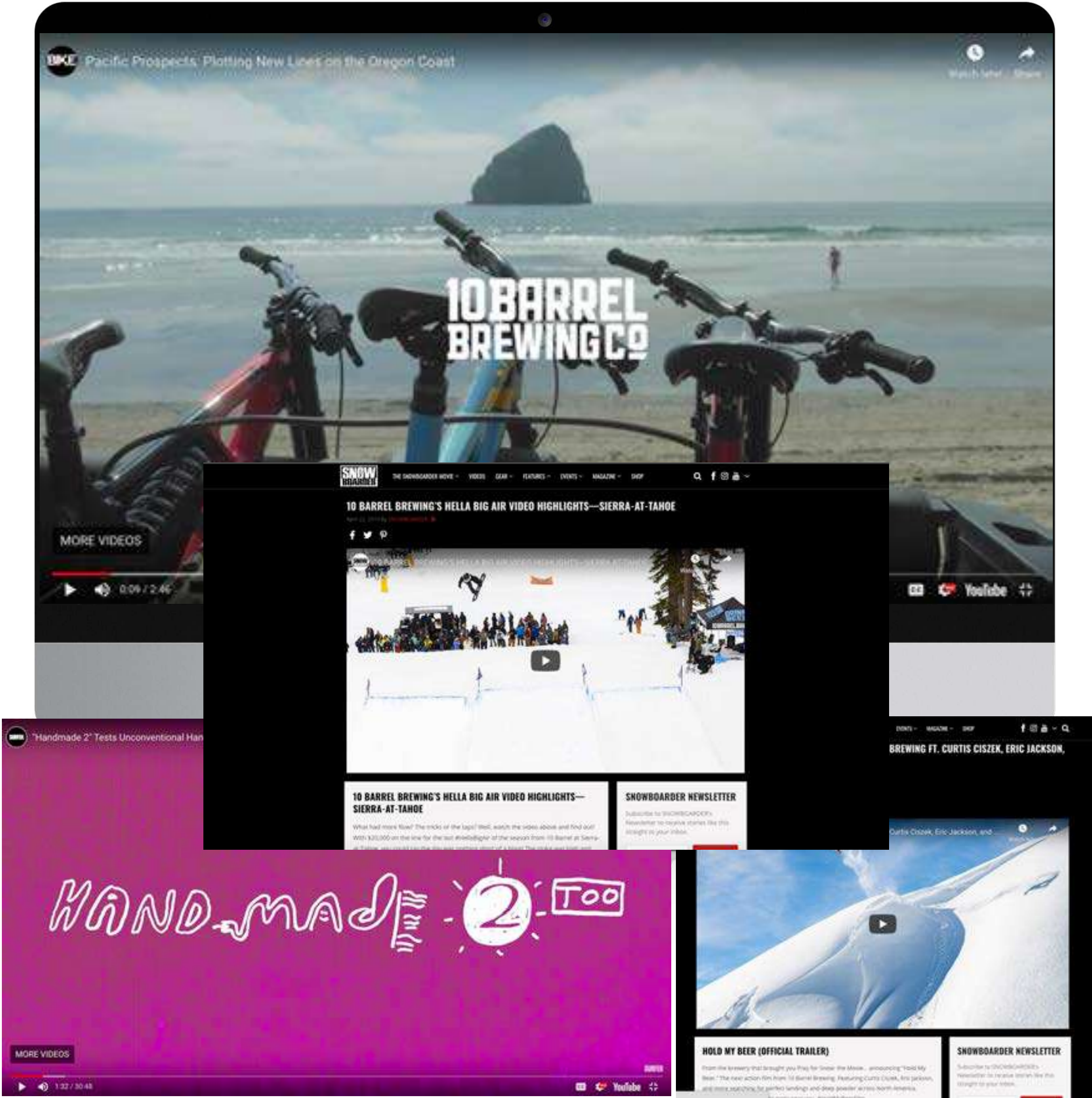
BREWING CO

PARTNER CHALLENGE:
10 Barrel has long been synonymous with having fun outdoors and enjoying great beer. But the brand had a need to create awareness and a connection with outdoor enthusiasts outside of their home base of the Pacific Northwest. 10 Barrel challenged the ASN group for the last 4 years to craft an all encompassing and yearly, integrated marketing campaign that would cement the 10 Barrel brand as an integral part of our audiences lifestyle across all of ASN's aligned categories, from surf and bike to snow and ski.

ASN'S STRATEGIC SOLUTION:
A tall order to fill and with no limit to opportunity, in 2019, ASN first went to town integrating the 10 Barrel brand into existing content franchises like SURFER's Handmade 2 film and Bike's Bike Hacks. These programs offered instant authenticity within each vertical and garnered immense organic exposure. Then we moved into the custom video realm with Bike's Trail Guide series that produced service-based mountain bike video around 10 Barrel's home of Oregon with 10 Barrel logo and beer placement. After content, ASN focused on supporting 10 Barrel's cans-in-hands strategy with integration into Snowboarder's Cold Front Tour film premiere series as well as supported 10 Barrels owned-and-operated Hella Big Air events and Pray For Snow films releases with social and digital promotion.

MY INVOLVEMENT:

- **COLLABORATIVE IDEATION:** Led creative discussions around content integration, custom branded video, experiential activation, and more (ASN Vertical Brand Editor-in-Chiefs, Group Content Director, Video Director, etc).
- **BUDGET MANAGEMENT:** Created a profit and loss model to price content production, integration, event activation and build supporting social distribution and digital media placements.
- **PROPOSAL PRODUCTION:** Produced campaign pitch from overall deck design to concept copy writing and content research (mood boards, locations, story angles, etc).
- **CAMPAIGN EXECUTION:** Oversaw Project Manager assigned to campaign and assisted Video Director and editors with behind-the-scene content production elements.
- **ROI REPORTING:** Created overall ROI presentation for 10 Barrel, reporting on program performance, identifying successes and weaknesses across every channel and activation.



INTEGRATED MARKETING PARTNERSHIPS

SIERRA NEVADA



PARTNER CHALLENGE:

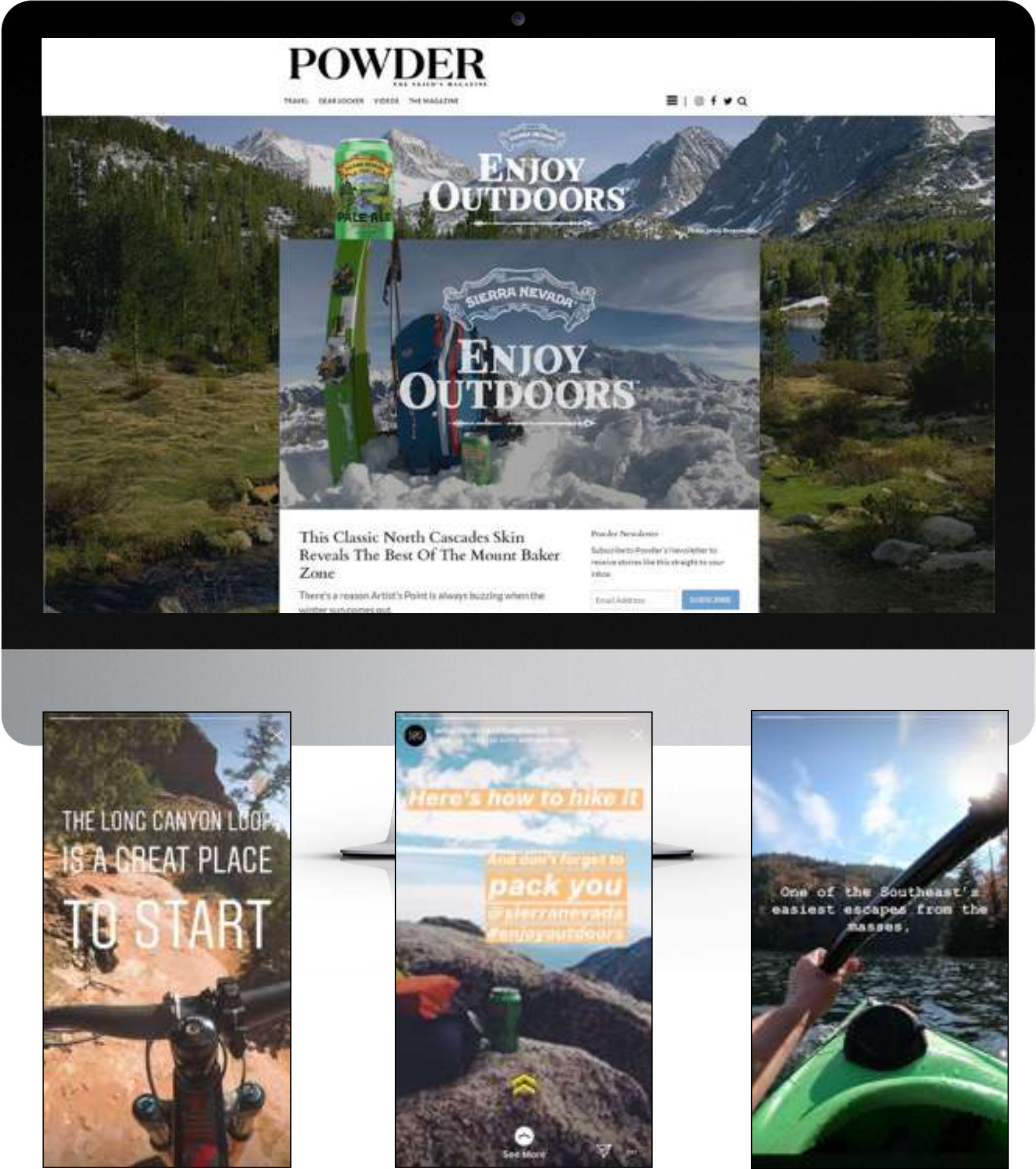
For the first time in Sierra Nevada’s history the brand ventured into a nationally executed marketing campaign called “Enjoy Outdoors”. Looking to solidify their flagship product, the Pale Ale, as the premier craft brew of choice for outdoor enthusiasts, Sierra Nevada approached Adventure Sports Network for a custom and integrated marketing partnership to drive engagement with a highly influential and active consumer.

ASN’S STRATEGIC SOLUTION:

Drawing a direct line between the places our audiences love to play outdoors with the perfect location to enjoy a hard earned Pale Ale, ASN produced a serviced-based content series to meet Sierra Nevada’s challenge. The campaign was designed to inspire our vertical audience members with snackable, social-first videos revolved around POV angles of mountain biking, skiing, hiking and kayaking through pristine nature scenes with cues on how to perform the adventure for yourself, ending in the cracking of a Sierra Nevada Pale Ale. Each content piece was distributed digitally and socially to geo-targeted key markets around the United States and supported by high-impact media placements, all resulting in impressive brand recall verified by a third-party brand lift study.

MY INVOLVEMENT:

- **COLLABORATIVE IDEATION:** Led creative discussions around the “Enjoy Outside” service-based content concept with key internal stakeholders throughout ASN (ASN Vertical Brand Editor-in-Chiefs, Group Content Director, Video Director, etc).
- **BUDGET MANAGEMENT:** Created a profit and loss model to price content production and build supporting geo-targeted social distribution and digital media placements.
- **PROPOSAL PRODUCTION:** Produced campaign pitch from overall deck design to concept copy writing and content research (mood boards, locations, story angles, etc).
- **CAMPAIGN EXECUTION:** Oversaw Project Manager assigned to campaign and assisted Video Director with behind-the-scene content production elements.
- **ROI REPORTING:** Created overall ROI presentation for Sierra Nevada, reporting on program performance, identifying successes and weaknesses across every channel.



INTEGRATED MARKETING PARTNERSHIPS



PARTNER CHALLENGE:

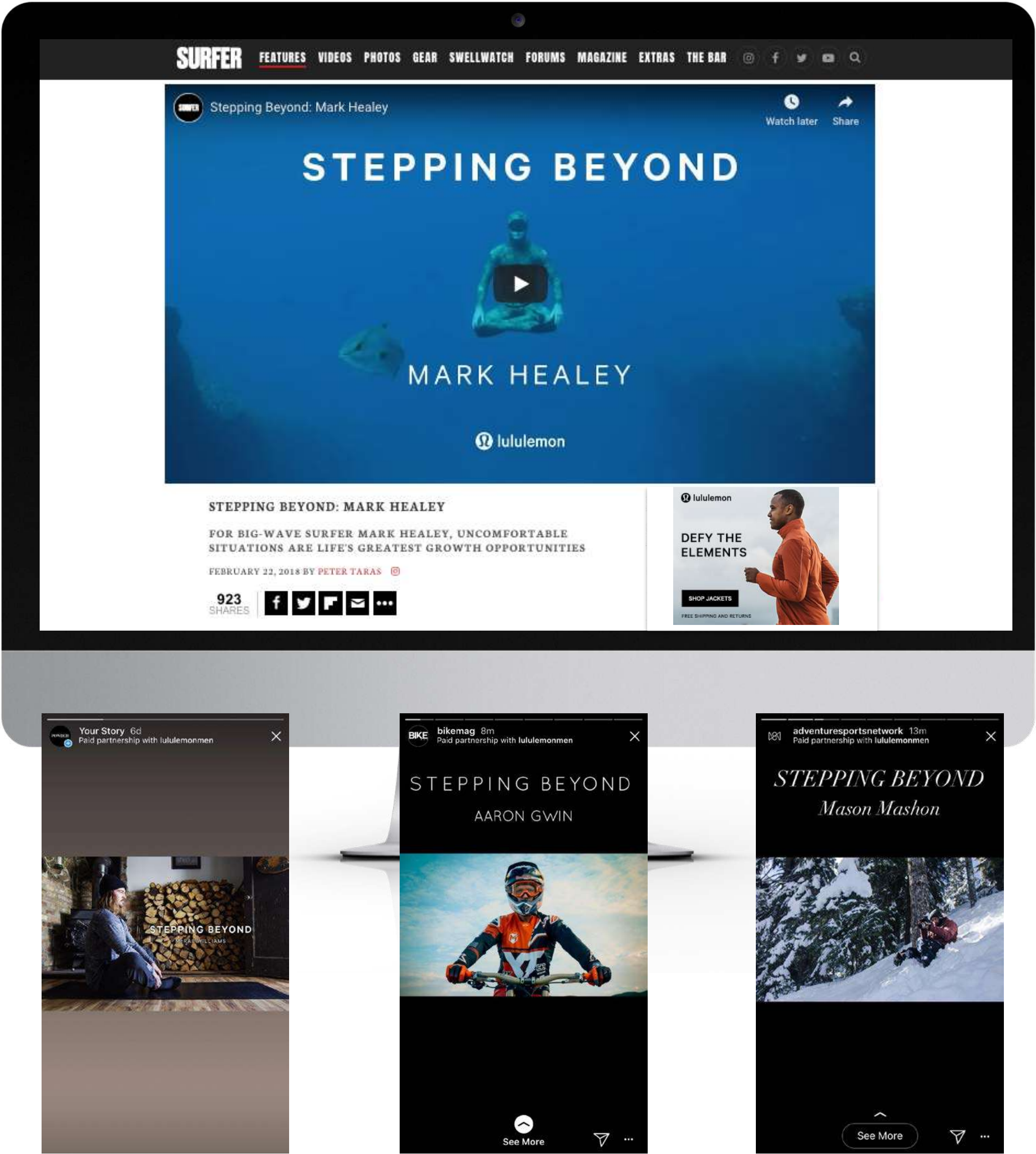
Through market research, the Lululemon Men’s brand team discovered not many male consumers within the outdoor space knew they created men’s apparel, nor identified with the brand. Looking to connect with consumers across the adventure sport category, Lululemon came to ASN to translate Lululemon’s brand message in an authentic way to engage with aspiring adventurous men everywhere.

ASN’S STRATEGIC SOLUTION:

With the knowledge above, the ASN team crafted a unique video series concept named, “Stepping Beyond.” Highlighting Lululemon Men’s elite ambassadors, this content series told a docu-style story around each subject, introducing them and the Lululemon Men’s brand to ASN’s sport-specific audiences. Using a network strategy, each “Stepping Beyond” episode was distributed to ASN’s vertical brands, aligning each ambassadors sport category with the corresponding audience. The campaign reached a total of **12.6M+** impressions and led to some of the most engaging branded content ASN has ever produced for a partner.

MY INVOLVEMENT:

- **COLLABORATIVE IDEATION:** Led creative discussions around the “Stepping Beyond” concept with key internal stakeholders throughout ASN (ASN Vertical Brand Editor-in-Chiefs, Group Content Director, Video Director, etc).
- **BUDGET MANAGEMENT:** Created a profit and loss model to price content production and build supporting social distribution and digital media placements.
- **PROPOSAL PRODUCTION:** Produced campaign pitch from overall deck design to concept copy writing and content research (athlete subjects, locations, story angles, etc).
- **CAMPAIGN EXECUTION:** Oversaw Project Manager assigned to campaign and assisted Video Director with behind-the-scene content production elements.
- **ROI REPORTING:** Created overall ROI presentation for Lululemon, reporting on program performance, identifying successes and weaknesses across every distribution channel.



INTEGRATED MARKETING PARTNERSHIPS

TOYOTA



PARTNER CHALLENGE:

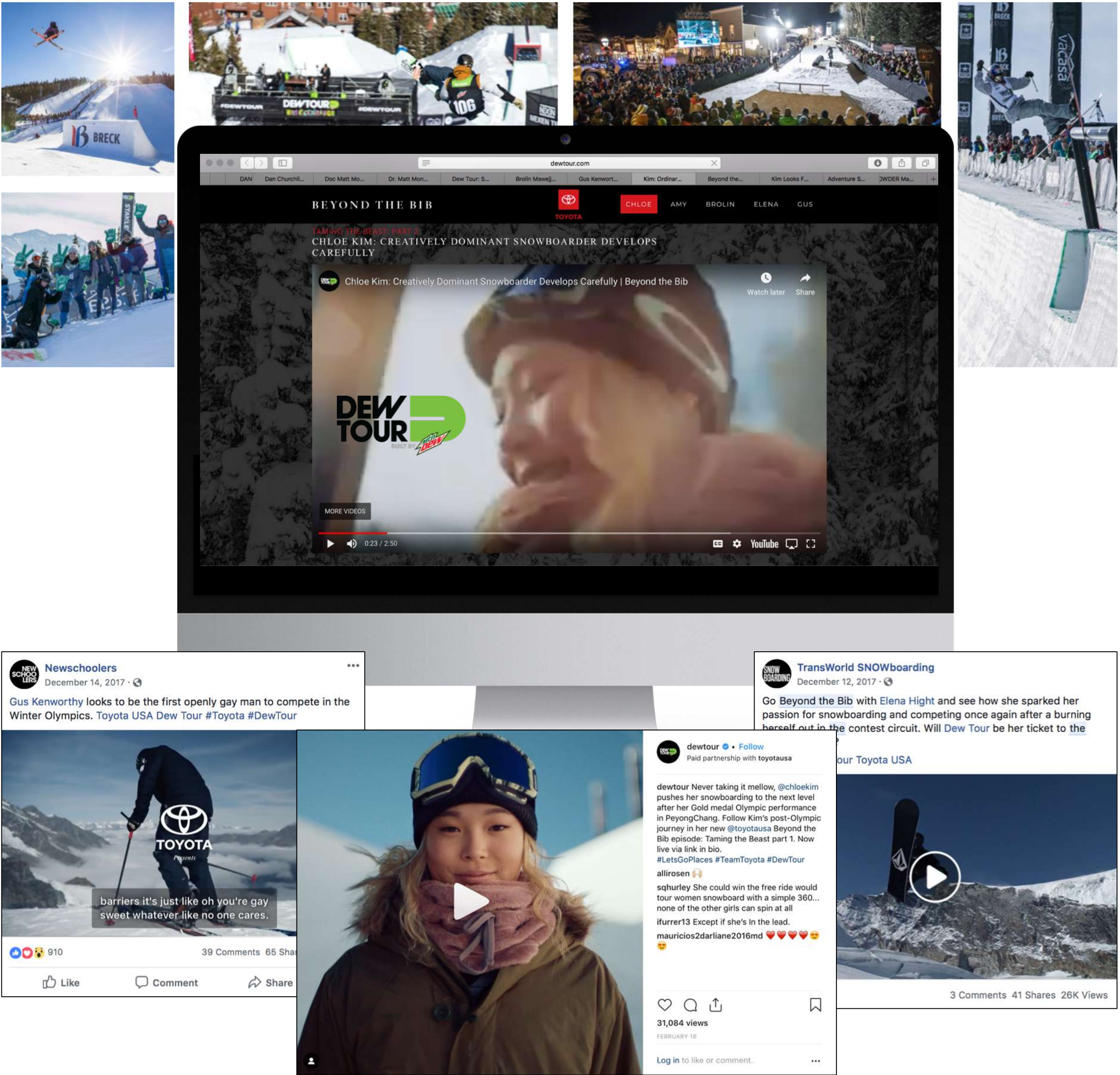
Toyota had historically been a partner of Dew Tour since the creation of the action sport event in 2005 but with ASN taking over the reigns as the franchise’s operator, Toyota pushed to have their partnership with the event re-imagined across all consumer touch points.

ASN’S STRATEGIC SOLUTION:

Through a new “Always On” digital and social strategy, ASN re-invented Dew Tour to bring content and competition to fans year-round, all supported by ASN’s sport-specific vertical brands. Utilizing this new experiential model, ASN crafted an omni-channel partnership for Toyota, anchored around custom branded content, custom competition elements, media (digital + social + broadcast) and on-site branding. Dew Tour and ASN we’re able to bring Toyota’s “Mobile Adaptability” mission to life through a key pillar of the program, a content series called, *Beyond The Bib*, giving their partnership, athletes and brand invaluable lift into the 2018 Winter Olympics.

MY INVOLVEMENT:

- **COLLABORATIVE IDEATION:** Led discussions around all of Toyota’s partnership deliverables with Dew Tour’s General Manager, Sponsorship Director, Content Director and Event Operations Director.
- **BUDGET MANAGEMENT:** Created a profit and loss model to price all of Toyota’s partnership elements, from custom branded content to owned event and competition deliverables.
- **PROPOSAL PRODUCTION:** Produced partnership pitch from overall deck design to deliverable copy writing and visual mock-ups of deliverables (competition element examples)
- **CAMPAIGN EXECUTION:** Assisted Dew Tour Sponsorship Director with high-level partnership management, from partner briefing to execution on-site at event, assisted Video Director with behind-the-scene content production elements.
- **ROI REPORTING:** Created overall ROI presentation for Toyota, reporting on program performance, identifying successes and weaknesses across every distribution channel.



INTEGRATED MARKETING PARTNERSHIPS

YETI

PARTNER CHALLENGE:

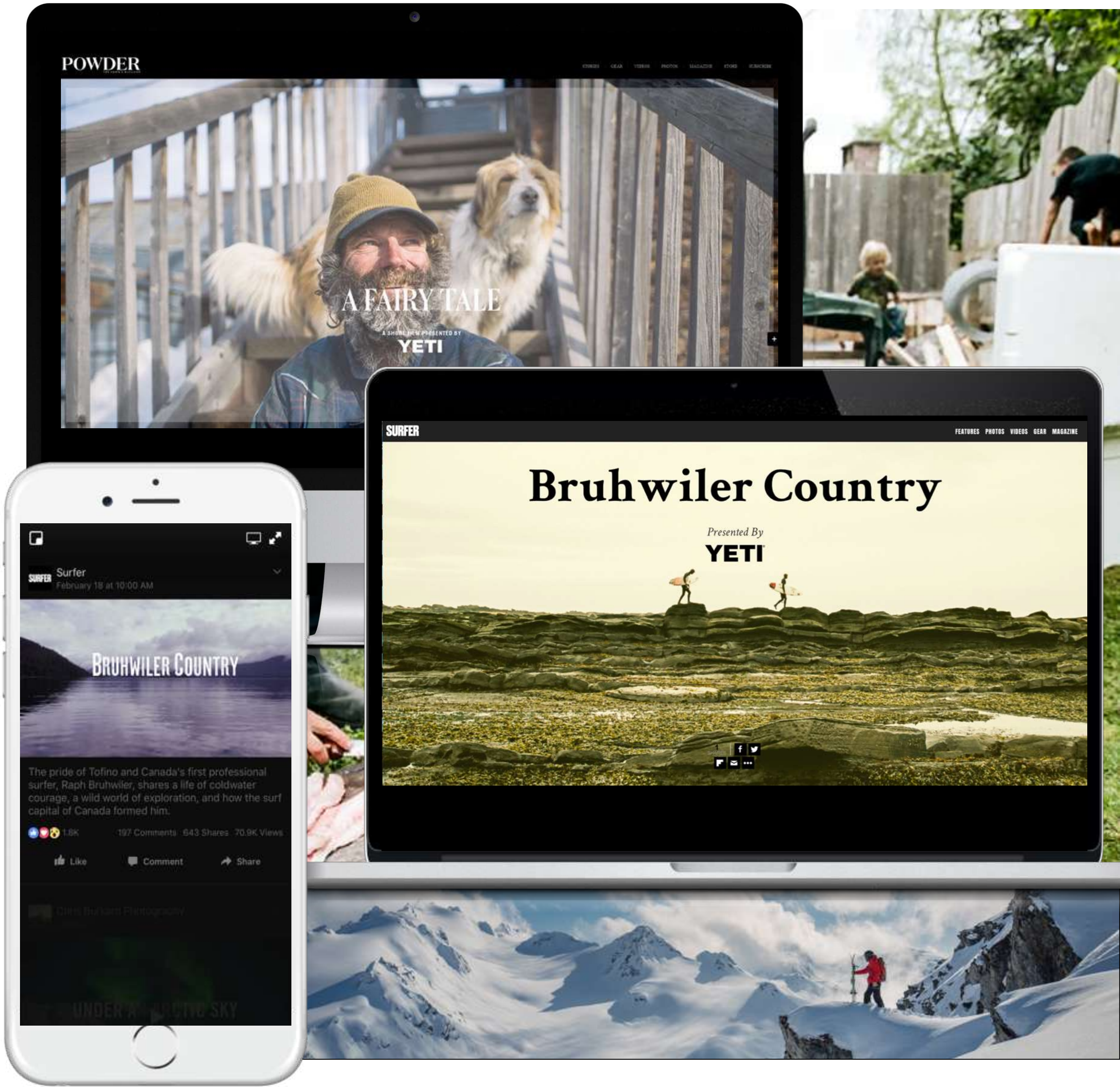
YETI had produced two films, one called *A Fair Tale*, revolved around a backwoods ski patrolmen and the other called *Bruhweiler Country*, highlighting the life of Raph Bruhwiler, former professional surfer and now Canadian coast guardsmen. Looking to connect with ski and surf enthusiasts, YETI leaned on ASN to find an engaged and core audience for their films.

ASN'S STRATEGIC SOLUTION:

In an effort to think outside of the box, the ASN team decided to look deeper than simply content articles to distribute YETI's new films. After a conversation with the YETI brand team, there was a realization that there was a deeper story to be told around each subject. Utilizing the SURFER and Powder brand channels, beautiful digital features were produced to add more color to each film, character and story. Each feature and subsequent social promotion garnered massive organic reach, ultimately being widely successful for the YETI brand.

MY INVOLVEMENT:

- **COLLABORATIVE IDEATION:** Led creative discussions around amplifying YETI's new branded surf and ski content with SURFER and Powder's Editor-in Chiefs.
- **BUDGET MANAGEMENT:** Created a profit and loss model to price digital feature production and supporting social distribution and digital media placements.
- **PROPOSAL PRODUCTION:** Produced campaign pitch from overall deck design to concept copy writing and content research (making the case for distributing content with SURFER and Powder's audiences).
- **CAMPAIGN EXECUTION:** Oversaw project manager assigned to campaign and assisted editors with any content production supported needed.
- **ROI REPORTING:** Created overall ROI presentation for YETI, reporting on program performance, identifying successes and weaknesses across every distribution channel.



GLOBAL BRAND MANAGEMENT

ARNETTE

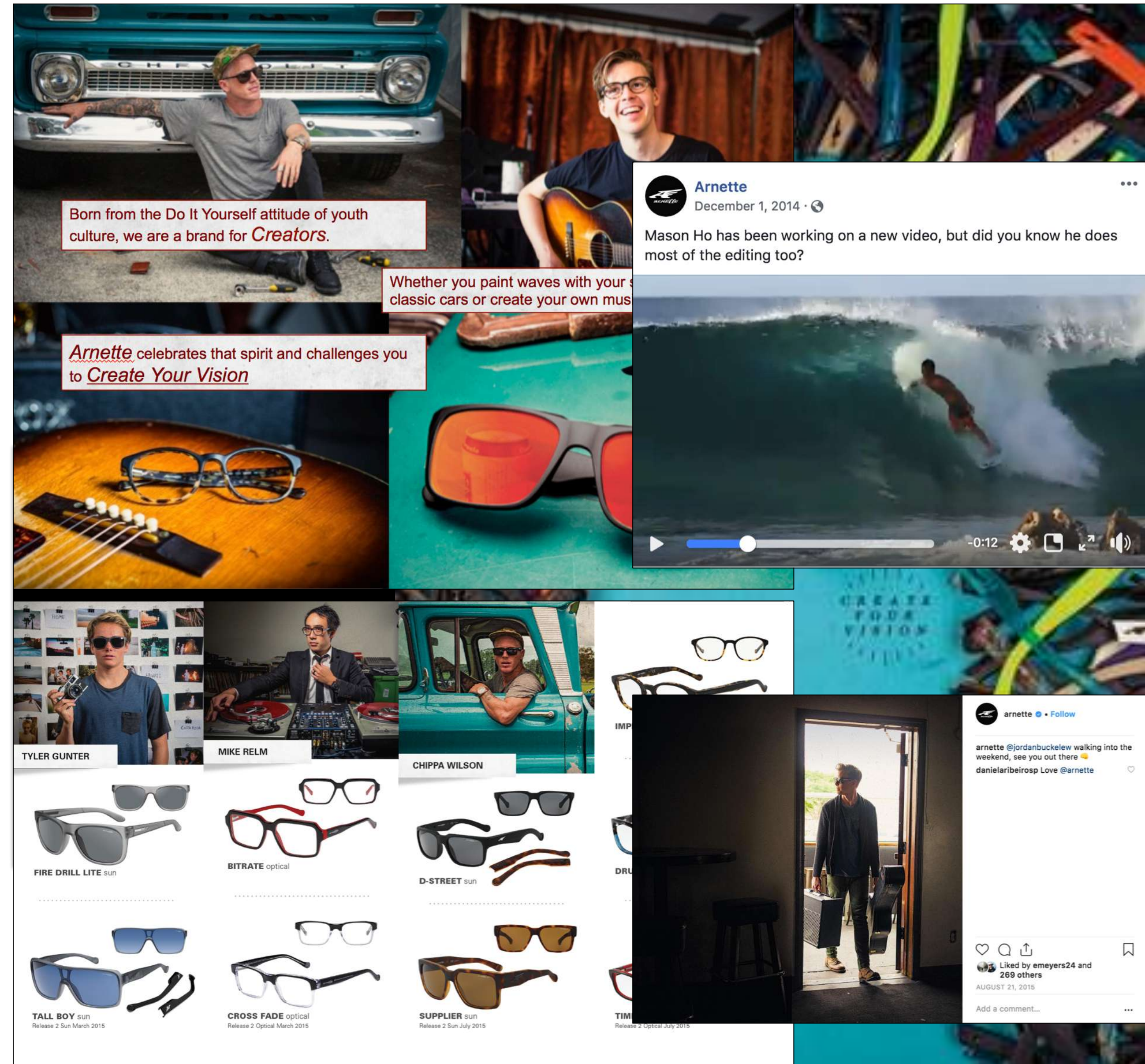


POSITION OVERVIEW | GLOBAL MARKETING SPECIALIST

During my time at Oakley I focused my energy on one of the organizations sister brands, Arnette Eyewear. As the marketing lead for Arnette, I planned yearly strategy for the brand, managing overall go-to-market efforts. I wore many hats and got a chance to touch many marketing types on the small team that made up Arnette's global brand marketing function. My colleagues included Arnette's Global Brand Director and Global Digital Specialist, supported by Oakley's infrastructure behind-the-scenes.

MY INVOLVEMENT:

- **BRAND PLANNING:** Crafted Arnette's brand positioning and messaging in market, planned seasonal go-to-market plans across every marketing channel and presented brand direction to Oakley's upper management.
- **CREATIVE DIRECTION:** Worked in collaboration with Arnette's creative agency-of-record to bring seasonal product stories, marketing collateral and branded content to life.
- **GLOBAL COLLABORATION:** Conferenced with global business units every quarter to ensure Arnette's brand campaigns were coming to life uniformly around the globe, fulfilled special creative asset requests, brought regional stories to life through Arnette's global digital channels.
- **TRADE MARKETING:** Managed seasonal GTM playbook, catalogue and point-of-purchase production, from creative ideation to printing and global distribution.
- **PUBLIC RELATIONS & EVENTS:** Collaborated with Arnette's PR agency-of-record to plan seasonal strategy around earned media, planned press and consumer facing events.
- **ATHLETES & INFLUENCERS:** Managed Arnette's professional team of surfers, snowboarders and skateboarders, integrated athlete stories into brand campaigns, crafted new artist influencer strategy to attract new consumers to the brand, planned contracts and payments.



GLOBAL DIGITAL & SOCIAL MANAGEMENT

ZQK BRANDS

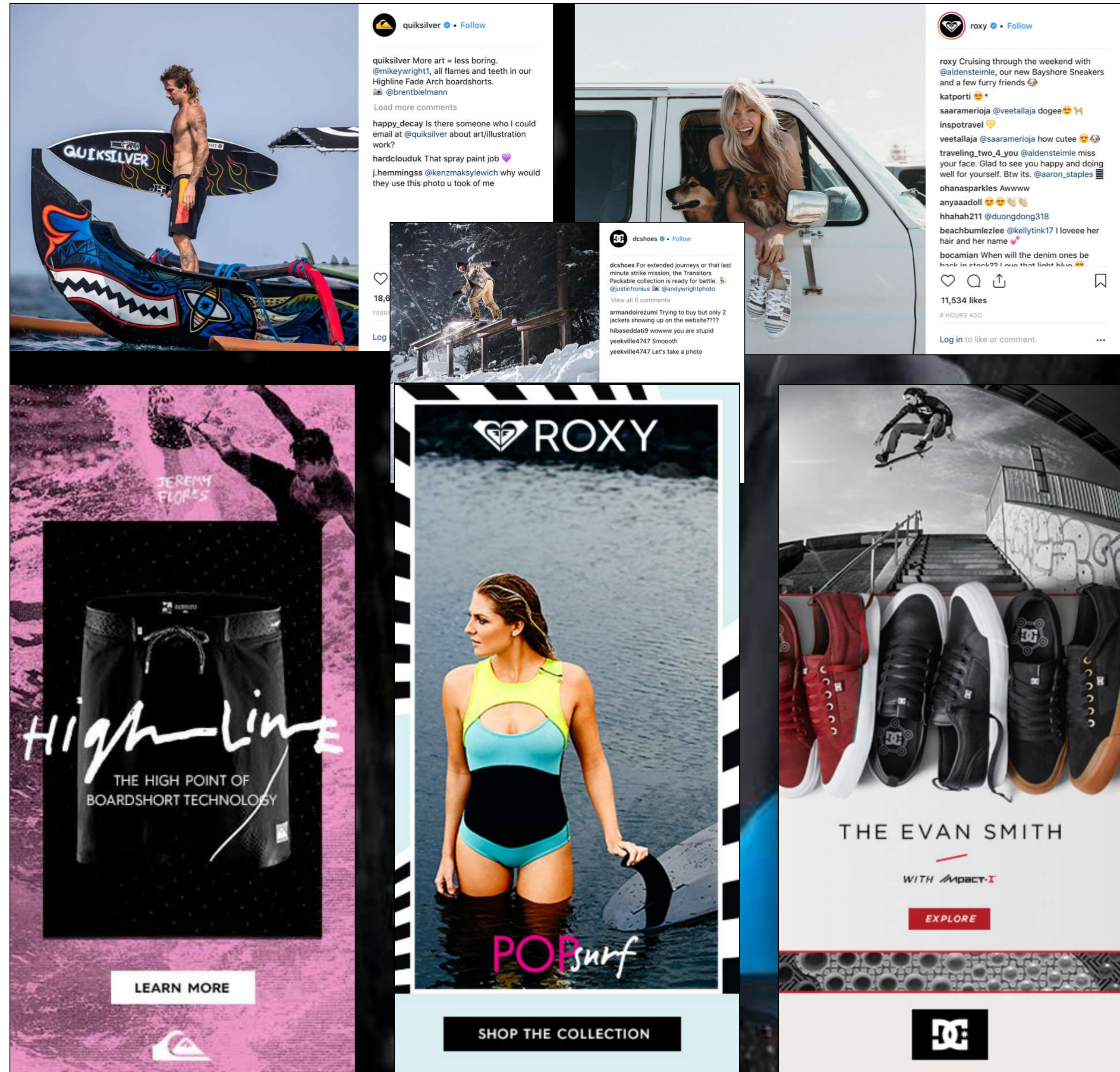


POSITION OVERVIEW | GLOBAL MARKETING ACTIVATION COORDINATOR

As part of Quiksilver's Global Marketing Activation Team, I focused on the organizations three owned brands, Quiksilver, Roxy and DC Shoes. Working under the Marketing Activation team's Global Media Director, I assisted in bringing digital and social brand campaigns to life across the globe. I also worked in tandem with each brands regional social leads to establish engaged communities and publish content to brand channels.

MY INVOLVEMENT:

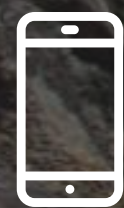
- **AGENCY COORDINATION:** Assisted Global Media Director in management of agency-of-record, led weekly status meetings with agency leads, processed vendor paperwork and payments.
- **DIGITAL STRATEGY:** Reviewed and suggested edits to global media recommendations set by agency, reported on media buying and deployment.
- **INFLUENCER PROGRAM:** Created an influencer and research program for the Quiksilver and DC Shoes brands, cultivated relationships with up-and-coming athletes and personalities, managed research gathering for product and brand campaign feedback.
- **COMMUNITY MANAGEMENT:** Assisted global social teams with content publishing, created style guides for community engagement, actively incubated conversation with consumers, solved any customer service issues that came through social platforms.



THANK YOU!

I can't thank you enough for taking the time to review my portfolio of work. I look forward to chatting you with about my marketing experience and discussing how I can help your brand grow.

Until then, cheers!



949-243-6586



Aaron.Santanello@gmail.com



[LinkedIn Profile](#)